

NEW RULES

Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020

- 1 Replaces 13 Central labour laws with a single comprehensive legislation
- 2 Simplifies single registration, streamlines compliances for all-India licences, electronic filings, and time-bound approvals, enables women to work at night
- 3 Widens the definition of interstate migrant worker, creates a national database to enrol unorganised workers, including migrants on the cards
- 4 Universal coverage of establishments for health, safety and welfare of workers, higher onus on employers for health and safety

Code on Social Safety, 2020

- 1 Consolidates nine existing social security laws and extends coverage to organised, unorganised, gig, and platform workers
- 2 Universal coverage under EPFO, social security benefits for fixed term employees
- 3 Unorganised, gig and platform workers brought under Act for social security
- 4 Benefits for women workers, including crèche facilities, work from home, medical bonus and nursing breaks

This marks a significant milestone since land and labour reforms have for long been key demands of investors and were seen as the logical next steps to improve the country's attractiveness as an investment destination, boost its flailing manufacturing

sector and create jobs for its teeming workforce.

Significantly, the decision to finally implement the Codes comes at a time when Indian goods face a stiff tariff of 50% from the US, which is disrupting most labour-intensive ex-

► The Centre on November 21 announced the implementation of the four Labour Codes that rationalise 29 existing labour laws

► This was a long-awaited reform that is expected to give employers more flexibility and benefit workers by guaranteeing benefits and social security

► But companies are waiting for the final rules, and are concerned about gratuity, salary structures

► Several central trade unions continue to oppose the Codes, and plan to strike in February 2026

► Will the Codes help improve India's competitiveness and attract investments needed to boost growth and create jobs?